

Game Design Proposal: Isla del Silencio

Development Team

IndieConnect	Name	Email
indieconnect.in/dev/ sarthak	Sarthak Anil Chaudh ari	sarthak.chaudhari@students.iiit .ac.in
indieconnect.in/dev/ notrko	Rishabh Kumar	notrko@gmail.com
indieconnect.in/dev/ vrishin2910	Vrishin Shah	vrishin2910@gmail.com
indieconnect.in/dev/ bhosalevedant0	Vedant Bhosale	bhosalevedant0@gmail.com

Executive Summary

Isla del Silencio is a narrative-driven, puzzle-adventure game heavily inspired by classic legacy dungeon mechanics. The game casts the player as a world-renowned, fiercely arrogant artifact hunter determined to debunk the myths of *Isla de Silencio*—an uncharted island infamous for consuming anyone who sets foot on it. Believing his expertise far exceeds the danger, he embarks on a solo expedition. However, his descent into the island's subterranean depths quickly strips away his hubris, plunging him into a distorted, looping reality where manipulating the electromagnetic spectrum is the only way to survive.

Narrative & Worldbuilding

The Premise:

The protagonist is a master excavator whose defining trait is his ego. Driven by a desire for absolute glory, he refuses a support team, intent on busting the rumors of the island alone. The initial stages of the game reflect this arrogance, but the environment rapidly shifts from a standard archaeological dig into a psychological trap.

The Twist (Distorted Reality):

The caverns operate within a fractured timeline. Throughout the game, the player discovers desperate hints, cryptic warnings, and scrawled puzzle solutions scattered

across the environment. The narrative climax delivers a psychological gut-punch: the protagonist has been trapped in an inescapable time loop. The hints were not left by previous doomed explorers, but by the protagonist himself during countless previous cycles, desperately leaving breadcrumbs in the hope that his future self might finally deduce the escape route.

Core Gameplay & Mechanics

The core gameplay loop requires meticulous exploration, environmental observation, and physics-based puzzle-solving driven entirely by the manipulation of light.

- **Legacy Dungeon Progression:** The game progresses linearly through distinct, self-contained environments or "rooms," channeling the intricate, interconnected puzzle design of legacy dungeons.
- **High-Stakes Failure State:** Progression is unforgiving. Making a critical error, failing a riddle, or triggering a trap results in immediate death. Upon dying, the timeline resets, and the player is forced to restart from the beginning of their current room.

Level Design: The Spectrum Rooms

The vertical slice of the game features three meticulously designed puzzle zones, each governed by a specific wavelength of light. To progress to the next level, the player must fully master the rules of the current spectrum.

1. The Visible Light Region

2. The Infrared Region

3. The Ultraviolet Region

Thematic Integration

The game is built strictly around three foundational themes, woven directly into both the aesthetic and mechanical design:

- **Comic:** To juxtapose the dark, looping narrative, the game's presentation layer heavily utilizes a graphic novel aesthetic. All narrative cutscenes play out as stylized comic panels with dynamic transitions. The main menu, UI elements, inventory screens, and the "Game Over" restart screens are designed with halftone patterns, bold inks, and comic-style typography, giving the game a distinct and striking visual identity.
- **Twist:** The revelation of the time loop is baked directly into the level design. The handwriting on the walls, the placement of the tools, and the very logic of the puzzles are subtle reflections of the protagonist's own mind. The realization that the player is competing against their own past failures provides a devastating narrative payoff.

- **Light:** Light is not just an aesthetic choice; it is the central mechanic binding the entire experience. By splitting the legacy dungeons into Visible, Infrared, and Ultraviolet spectrums, the gameplay constantly forces the player to change their literal and metaphorical perspective to overcome the island's distorted reality.